

INVENTORY · STACK · STRUCTURE

# cards-stack

Parallel items stacked vertically, full-width cards.

## When to reach for cards-stack.

**Vertical reading order matters.** The audience scans top to bottom, not grid-style. Each card builds on the previous one as the eye moves down the slide.

**Each card has more body than a grid card.** Two sentences instead of one. cards-grid forces parallel density; cards-stack lets each card breathe with longer body text.

**Two to three items, not four-plus.** Beyond three cards the slide overflows. For more items, split across multiple slides or switch to cards-grid with shorter text.

## Three patterns, each with its own pull.

**Inventory.** Equal-weight items the audience scans without ordering. The cards-grid family lives here — grid, stack, wide, side.

**Comparison.** Two or more items weighed against shared criteria. The verdict and compare families live here — they take sides.

**Progression.** Items that carry an explicit sequence. The list-steps and timeline families live here — order is load-bearing.

## Three reasons to keep cards-stack at three items.

1

### Cognitive load

Three is the threshold the audience can hold without effort. Past three, the slide demands working memory the room shouldn't have to spend.

2

### Vertical real estate

Each stacked card needs ~30% of the slide height to breathe. Four cards force you to shrink the cards until they stop reading as cards.

3

### Build path symmetry

cards-stack pairs with cards-grid (3-4 items) and cards-wide (3-4 rows). Keeping cards-stack at 2-3 keeps the family's choices clean.

## When NOT to reach for cards-stack.

### Four or more items.

The stack overflows past three. For four parallel items reach for cards-grid four; for richer per-item bodies, cards-wide handles three or four rows.

### One-line cards.

If each card is a single short phrase, the stack or reads as a padded list. Drop to and reclaim the vertical space.

tldr

### Forced sequence.

Cards-stack is parallel content read in vertical order, not a numbered sequence. For explicit steps, use list-steps or list-criteria.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

- `cards-grid` — three or four parallel items in a scannable grid
- `cards-wide` — three or four rows with more substantial per-card body
- `cards-side` — exactly two items in left-right balance
- `list-steps` — items carry an explicit, ordered sequence